data may come from, for example, just a few, unrepresentative sources which happen to be easiest to access or digest.

Second, the data may not be adequate regarding the time it represents. Let's imagine someone making budgeting decisions based on the quarterly results of their team, and they usually do it after the data for the previous quarter is provided to them. If this person is required to make their decision earlier, their accuracy may suffer. They will base their decision on inadequate data related to previous quarters.

Finally, the data may be inconclusive. If the analysis is appropriately designed, one of the expected and valid outcomes should be the answer "based on the collected data, we cannot distinguish between two options." Without access to additional data, the usual approach, summarized with "get me some type of answer," is as reliable as the good old coin toss.

It all comes down to the known truth: having the data is not equal to having insight. The data governance in this situation may help by ensuring that users have access to well-described metadata, revealing the actual information content of the data used. But that is not all data governance offers to people looking to increase the business value of collected data.

Data governance also enables the effective use of data to derive business value, ensuring that users have a deeper comprehension of the meaning behind numbers stored in tables. It is made possible thanks to the governed terminology directories, master data management, cooperation between the business people and data crowd on, for example, naming conventions, data quality measures, and data processing.

It is easy to find a straight path to a declaration that data governance, via the improved understanding of the organization's business models and data-driven decision-making, leads to enhanced business planning and increased operational efficiency.

6.2.2 Data usability perspective

Data governance can also add value to the business from the data usability perspective. Working with data in a large organizations often comes with